

Malaria

You help families prevent malaria and get to a test quickly. Malaria medicine is given only to people with a confirmed test, by a trained health worker.

For health workers

Key messages

- Send anyone with a fever for a test within 24 hours, using a rapid test or blood slide at the health facility, or through a trained community malaria volunteer.
- Do not give malaria medicine for fever alone. Refer pregnant women with signs of malaria to the facility for testing and treatment.
- Explain why the full three days of treatment must be finished, and that the medicine is free.
- Help make sure every household gets a net when nets are given out (about every three years), especially pregnant women.

Help families hang nets properly.

- At home visits, check that nets are hung and have no tears or holes.
- Teach families to clear bush and empty puddles. Tell pregnant women about malaria prevention tablets at ANC.
- Record your referrals and work with the ward health committee and community malaria volunteers.

Refer immediately if the patient has

- Fits, confusion or unusual sleepiness
- Cannot drink or keeps vomiting
- Very pale skin or yellow eyes
- Fast or difficult breathing
- Fever in a pregnant woman or a baby

Run a village session

1. Meet in a shaded, central place at a time when families can come. Greet everyone and say what today's topic is.

2. Ask what people already know and what they have heard. Listen first.
3. Share three key messages from this page in your local language. Use pictures and real examples from the village.
4. Ask people to say the messages back in their own words, and answer questions.
5. Agree on one action the village will take this month. Refer anyone who is unwell, and record who came.

General information only. Follow the advice of your health centre and current national guidelines. Based on the National Department of Health Village Health Assistant (VHA) training curriculum.